

Absolutely — **successful** is a strong secondary polysemy/family target because your passage uses it repeatedly:

> “A **successful** small business that I know about...”

> “I think this business is **successful** for several reasons.”

Here **successful** means **achieving good results in business**, especially being able to attract customers, maintain quality, build a reputation, and continue operating well. But the family also covers **success in reaching goals, social/professional success, a successful event/product, and related forms such as succeed / success / successfully**.

Word family: **success / succeed / successful / successfully**

Base noun: success

Verb: succeed

Adjective: successful

Adverb: successfully

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞)

Meaning in your passage: **successful = achieving good business results — 成功的；經營有成的**

Your sentence:

> “A **successful small business** that I know about...”

Here **successful** means:

> **achieving good results in its business activities, such as attracting customers, maintaining quality, building loyalty, and remaining viable.**

繁體中文：

在經營上取得良好成果，能吸引客戶、保持品質、建立口碑並持續營運的；成功的、經營有成的

Natural translation:

> “a **successful small business**”

「一間**經營成功的小型企業**」

So here:

> **successful = 在商業經營上取得理想成果**

1. **successful = achieving the intended result — 成功的；達成目標的**

The broad core meaning.

Practice 1

> “The campaign was **successful**.”

「這次活動很**成功**。」

Practice 2

> “The plan was successful in attracting new customers.”

「這個計劃成功**吸引了新顧客**。」

successful = 達到原本預期的目標或結果

This is the broadest modern meaning.

2. **successful = doing well in business/career — 成功的；事業有成的**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “Golden Crust is a **successful** small business.”

「Golden Crust 是一間**經營成功的小型企業**。」

Practice 4

> “She built a successful bakery from a very small shop.”

「她從一間很小的店開始，建立了一間**成功的麵包店**。」

successful — business/career = 在經營、工作或職業發展上取得持續而明顯的好成果

3. **successful = having achieved wealth/status/recognition — 成就卓越的；事業成功的**

A person-focused sense.

Practice 5

> “He became a **successful** entrepreneur.”

「他成為了一位**事業成功的企業家**。」

Practice 6

> “She is one of the most successful designers in the city.”

「她是城中**最成功 / 成就最高**的設計師之一。」

successful — person = 在事業、收入、地位、名聲或成就方面取得顯著成果的

This can imply different things depending on context:

- * money
- * career
- * reputation
- * achievement

4. **successful** = working effectively / producing the desired effect — 奏效的；有效成功的

A useful result-oriented sense.

Practice 7

> “The new marketing strategy was highly **successful**.”

「新的市場推廣策略非常**奏效**。」

Practice 8

> “The treatment was **successful**.”

「這項治療**成功 / 奏效**。」

successful = 某方法、程序或行動達到預期效果

Natural Chinese may be:

- * 成功的
- * 奏效的
- * 有效的

depending on domain.

5. **successful = event/project completed well — 圓滿成功的；順利的**

A common event/project sense.

Practice 9

> “The opening event was very **successful**.”

「開幕活動非常**成功 / 圓滿**。」

Practice 10

> “The project was successfully completed on time.”

「這個項目按時**順利完成**。」

successful = 活動、項目、計劃等進行順利並達到預期成果

6. **successful = accepted/approved after an application/attempt — 成功獲批的；成功通過的**

A common formal/institutional use.

Practice 11

> “Her application was **successful**.”

「她的申請**成功獲批**。」

Practice 12

> “Only successful candidates will be contacted.”

「只有**成功獲選的候選人**會收到聯絡。」

successful = 申請、競爭或甄選最終獲得批准 / 通過

This does not mean “the application itself was skillful”; it means the outcome was positive.

7. **success = achievement of desired result — 成功；達成目標**

The core noun.

Practice 13

> “The business became a **success**.”

「這間生意變得非常**成功**。」

Practice 14

> “Hard work does not always guarantee success.”

「努力並不一定能保證**成功**。」

success = 達成預期目標或取得理想成果的狀態 / 結果

8. **a success = successful person/event/product — 成功的人 / 事 / 產品**

A countable noun use.

Practice 15

> “The new cake was a huge **success**.”

「這款新蛋糕非常**成功 / 大受歡迎**。」

Practice 16

> “The event was a great success.”

「這場活動取得了**很大的成功**。」

a success = 一個取得很好成果的人、產品、活動或計劃

Important:

> success = 成功這個概念

> a success = 一個成功的人 / 事物

9. **success = prosperity / achievement in life or career — 成就；成功人生**

A broader social/career sense.

Practice 17

> “People define **success** in different ways.”

「人們對**成功**有不同定義。」

Practice 18

> “For her, success means having meaningful work.”

「對她來說，**成功**意味著擁有有意義的工作。」

success = 一個人在生活、事業或人生目標上所達到的成就

This can be subjective.

10. **succeed = achieve what you intended — 成功；達成目標**

The core verb.

Practice 19

> “The bakery **succeeded** because it focused on quality.”

「這間麵包店因專注品質而**成功**。」

Practice 20

> “If you keep improving, you are more likely to succeed.”

「如果你持續改進，就更有可能**成功**。」

succeed = 達成自己原本想達到的目標

11. **succeed in + noun/-ing = 成功做到.....**

A major grammar pattern.

Practice 21

> “The shop **succeeded in building** customer loyalty.”

「這間店**成功建立了**顧客忠誠度。」

Practice 22

> “She succeeded in opening a second branch.”

「她**成功開設了**第二間分店。」

succeed in doing = 經過努力後成功完成某件事

Important:

> **succeed in doing** 

> ***succeed to do***  normally

12. **succeed** = do well / become successful in career/business — 取得成就；事業成功

Practice 23

> “He wanted to **succeed in business**.”

「他**希望在商業上取得成功**。」

Practice 24

> “She succeeded as a baker.”

「她**作為麵包師取得了成功**。」

succeed in/as = 在某領域 / 身分中取得好成果

13. **succeed** = come after someone in a position — 接任；繼任

A genuinely distinct formal meaning.

Practice 25

> “She **succeeded** him as manager.”

「她**接替他出任經理**。」

Practice 26

> “The new director **succeeded** the founder.”

「**新任董事****接替了創辦人**。」

succeed someone = 在某人之後接任其職位 / 地位

This is a major lexical sense and should definitely be kept separate.

14. **succeed to + title/property** (法律 / 正式) — **繼承**

A related formal/legal use.

Practice 27

> “He **succeeded to** the family title.”

「他**繼承了家族頭銜**。」

Practice 28

> “She **succeeded to** the estate after his death.”

「他去世後，她**繼承了那份產業**。」

succeed to X = 正式繼承頭銜、財產或權利

Register:

* formal

* legal

* less common in everyday English

15. **successfully** = with a successful result — 成功地；順利地

Practice 29

> “The bakery **successfully** expanded its menu.”

「這間麵包店**成功地**擴充了餐單。」

Practice 30

> “The problem was **successfully** resolved.”

「問題已**順利解決**。」

successfully = 最後達到預期或理想結果地

16. **successful in + field/activity** = 在.....方面成功的

Practice 31

> “The bakery has been **successful** in attracting regular customers.”

「這間麵包店在吸引熟客方面很**成功**。」

Practice 32

> “She is **successful** in business.”

「她在商業上很**成功**。」

successful in X = 在某個領域、活動或任務中取得理想成果

17. **successful at + activity** = 擅長並成功做到.....

Practice 33

> “The shop is **successful** at building customer loyalty.”

「這間店很善於並成功地**建立顧客忠誠度**。」

Practice 34

> “He is **successful** at turning ideas into products.”

「他很擅長把想法**成功轉化為產品**。」

successful at X = 在某項活動中常能取得好成果

18. **commercially successful = 商業上成功的**

A useful compound.

Practice 35

> “The product was **commercially successful**.”

「這個產品在**商業上很成功**。」

Practice 36

> “A film can be artistic but not commercially successful.”

「一部電影可以很有藝術性，但未必在**商業上成功**。」

commercially successful = 在銷售、收入、盈利或市場表現方面取得好成果

19. **successful outcome = 成功結果；理想結果**

Practice 37

> “Careful planning improves the chance of a **successful outcome**.”

「仔細規劃可以提高取得**理想結果**的機會。」

Practice 38

> “The negotiation ended in a successful outcome.”

「談判最終取得了**成功結果**。」

successful outcome = 最終符合目標 / 期望的結果

Important distinction: **successful vs success**

successful

adjective:

> “a successful bakery”

= 一間成功的麵包店

success

noun:

> “The bakery is a success.”

= 這間麵包店很成功 / 是一個成功案例

Important distinction: **success vs a success**

success

uncountable:

= 成功這個概念 / 狀態

> “Success takes time.”

「成功需要時間。」

a success

countable:

= 一件成功的事 / 一個成功的人或產品

> “The new cake was a success.”

「新蛋糕很成功。」

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **successful vs effective**

You already have **effective** mapped.

****effective****

= produces the intended effect.

****successful****

= achieves the overall intended result.

> effective advertising

> = 有效廣告

> successful business

> = 成功企業

Something can be effective in one task without making the whole project successful.

Important distinction: ****successful vs profitable****

****profitable****

= makes financial profit.

****successful****

= broader:

may involve profit, growth, customer loyalty, impact, reputation, survival, etc.

A business may be successful by several measures, not just profit.

Important distinction: ****successful vs popular****

****popular****

= liked by many people.

****successful****

= achieves its goals/results.

A bakery may be popular but financially unsuccessful.

Or commercially successful without being universally popular.

Important distinction: **successful vs famous**

famous

= widely known.

successful

= achieved good results.

Someone can be successful without being famous.

Important distinction: **successful vs wealthy**

wealthy

= having a lot of money/assets.

successful

= broader achievement.

A successful teacher or artist need not be wealthy.

Important distinction: **successful vs accomplished**

accomplished

= highly skilled, especially in an art/profession.

successful

= achieved good outcomes.

> accomplished pianist

> = 技藝高超的鋼琴家

> successful pianist

> = 事業 / 演出成績成功的鋼琴家

Not identical.

Important distinction: ****succeed vs achieve****

****succeed****

= achieve the desired overall result.

****achieve****

usually takes an object:

> achieve a goal

Compare:

> “She succeeded.”

> = 她成功了。

> “She achieved her goal.”

> = 她達成目標。

Not:

> *achieved* alone in the same way.

Important distinction: ****succeed vs win****

****win****

= come first / defeat others / gain a prize.

****succeed****

= achieve a goal, which may involve no competition.

> win a competition

> = 贏得比賽

> succeed in business

> = 在商業上成功

Important distinction: **succeed in doing vs succeed someone**

This is one of the strongest polysemy contrasts.

Achieve:

> “She succeeded in opening another branch.”

= 她成功開了另一間分店。

Replace:

> “She succeeded him as manager.”

= 她接替他成為經理。

Same verb, completely different meaning.

Important distinction: **succeed in vs succeed to**

succeed in + -ing

= 成功完成.....

succeed to + title/property

= 繼承頭銜 / 財產

> succeed in opening a shop

> = 成功開店

> succeed to the title

> = 繼承頭銜

Excellent formal grammar contrast.

Important distinction: **successful application vs successful business**

successful application

= 申請獲批

successful business

= 生意經營有成

Same adjective, different contextual Chinese.

Important distinction: **success is guaranteed vs successful**

Your passage also has **guarantee**.

> “Success is never guaranteed.”

Here:

* **success** = 成功這個結果

* **guaranteed** = 一定會發生、有保證

> “a successful business”

Here:

* **successful** = 已經取得好成果的

So one describes the **result noun**, the other the **entity achieving that result**.

Important distinction: **successful = one-time result vs sustained success**

Context matters.

> “a successful event”

> may mean one event went well.

> “a successful business”

> usually suggests sustained positive performance over time.

So the Chinese nuance differs:

* 活動成功

* 經營有成

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **successful — achieve intended result** = 成功的
- * **successful — business/career** = 經營 / 事業有成的
- * **successful — person** = 成就卓越 / 事業成功的
- * **successful — method/treatment** = 奏效 / 成功的
- * **successful — event/project** = 圓滿 / 順利成功的
- * **successful — application/candidate** = 成功獲批 / 獲選的
- * **success — general** = 成功
- * **a success** = 成功的人 / 事 / 產品
- * **success — life/career achievement** = 成就
- * **succeed — achieve goal** = 成功
- * **succeed in doing** = 成功做到.....
- * **succeed in/as** = 在某領域 / 身分取得成功
- * **succeed someone** = 接任 / 繼任某人
- * **succeed to** = 繼承頭銜 / 財產
- * **successfully** = 成功地 / 順利地
- * **commercially successful** = 商業上成功的
- * **successful outcome** = 理想 / 成功結果

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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successful — general	達到原本預期目標或取得理想結果的
successful — business/career	在經營、工作或職業發展上取得持續而明顯好成果的
successful — person	在事業、成就、地位或名聲方面取得顯著成果的
successful — method/procedure	某方法、程序或行動達到預期效果的
successful — event/project	活動 / 項目進行順利並達到預期成果的
successful — application	申請、甄選或競爭最終獲得批准 / 通過的
success — uncountable	達成預期目標或取得理想成果的狀態
a success	一個取得良好成果的人、產品、活動或計劃
succeed	成功達成自己想要的結果
succeed in doing	經努力後成功完成某件事
succeed someone	在某人之後接任其職位 / 地位
succeed to	正式繼承頭銜、財產或權利
successfully	最後達到預期 / 理想結果地
commercially successful	在銷售、收入、盈利或市場表現方面成功的

For your original passage

You have two especially clear uses:

> “A **successful small business** that I know about...”

and:

> “I think this business is **successful** for several reasons.”

The exact meaning is:

successful = Golden Crust 在經營上做得好：品質穩定、有熟客、靠口碑建立名聲、有清晰定位，而且有能力持續營運和成長。

Natural translation:

> **「一間我知道的、經營成功的小型企業.....」**

and:

> **「我覺得這間生意之所以成功，有好幾個原因。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **successful business** → 經營成功的企業
- > **successful person** → 事業 / 成就成功的人
- > **successful treatment** → 奏效的治療
- > **successful application** → 成功獲批的申請
- > **success** → 成功
- > **a success** → 一件 / 一個成功的人事物
- > **succeed in doing** → 成功做到.....
- > **succeed someone** → 接任某人
- > **succeed to a title** → 繼承頭銜
- > **successful vs profitable** → 整體成功 vs 有盈利